

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance School of the Year

Dance School of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Clear, specific achievements from the past year and why they matter.
- Evidence of positive impact on students, staff, or the wider community.
- A clearly articulated ethos and set of values.
- Thoughtful support for students with different goals and pathways.
- Clear safeguarding procedures embedded in everyday practice.
- Awareness of student wellbeing and duty of care.
- Evidence of commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in policies, practice, and culture.
- Strong leadership and professional standards.
- A compelling overall case for why the school stands out.

Email *

lynseybritton@googlemail.com

Full Name *

Lynsey Gordon

Email *

lynseybritton@googlemail.com

Phone Number *

07973308741

Dance School Name *

The Britton School of Performing Arts

1. Tell us 3 things you are most proud of your school achieving in the last year. *

1. Opening our new purpose-built home

One of our proudest achievements has been opening BSPA's new premises in Letchworth. Designed to support the growing needs of our students, the facility provides three dedicated studio spaces as well as a private singing room, a parents' waiting room and a recreational student 'hub' area for the students to socialise in-between classes.

The building of these new studios has allowed us to expand our timetable, improve the learning experience and welcome more young people into the performing arts. This milestone represents years of hard work, a long-held dream and an investment into our local community. We believe that our studios will ensure that future generations of students will have access to high-quality training in a professional, inspiring environment.

2. Achieving excellence on both National and International stages

Our competition students have continued to excel at all festivals and competitions that we attend, building upon our reputation as one of the UK's leading dance schools. Over the past year, BSPA students have achieved outstanding results at prestigious competitions. Notable achievements have been an incredible 6 golds, 1 silver, 2 bronze, three 4th place and one 5th place, as well as 5 Gala invites and 2 runners-up awards in the Grand Final at this year's Dance World Cup Finals!! An amazing 103 entries qualified to this year's regional finals of the All England Dance Competition with 19 entries qualifying to National Finals which begin this week!! BSPA have also been crowned overall winners for 2 year's running at the So You Want To Dance Final with multiple students being awarded scholarships and agency representation.

Whilst we are incredibly proud of the medals and accolades, what we love to see is the confidence, resilience, teamwork and personal growth that our students gain through these experiences. We have been so impressed by the development of all our students over this past year.

3. Creating opportunities for every child to thrive

We are particularly proud of the supportive and inclusive environment we have created at BSPA, where students of all abilities and aspirations feel valued and part of our very special community. Whether a child attends one class a week for fun or is pursuing professional training, every student is encouraged to develop confidence, creativity and self-belief. Over the last year we have continued to expand opportunities through performances, examinations, workshops and community events, ensuring that every student has the chance to shine. From our bi-annual whole school dance show in which over 130 students had the fantastic opportunity to perform on a beautiful large stage at a local theatre to our 100% pass rate on both ISTD and Mountview examinations. As well as incredible masterclass opportunities with West End performers and International choreographers.

2. How would you describe your school's ethos and values? *

At BSPA, we believe that every child deserves to feel both supported and celebrated.

Our ethos is built around celebrating individual growth and development as well as encouraging teamwork and collaboration.

Each student is on their own unique journey and our teaching faculty excel at both celebrating and challenging our pupils at whatever point of their journey they are at and are committed to helping every student reach their individual potential.

We strive to create a safe space where students can develop not only as performers but as confident, kind and resilient individuals.

We pride ourselves on fostering an environment where younger students are inspired and driven by the achievements of our senior students and our senior students in turn look out for the younger pupils and assist our teaching staff in younger classes.

We are passionate about providing high-quality training whilst still maintaining a nurturing atmosphere where students feel safe to take risks, challenge themselves and enjoy the process of learning and developing their skills. We always celebrate effort as much as achievement and recognise that success looks different for every student.

3. How do you support both recreational and aspiring professional students? *

We recognise that every student is on their own unique path and we are committed to supporting a wide range of ambitions.

For our recreational students, our focus is on enjoyment, confidence-building, friendship and personal growth. We provide regular performance opportunities, examinations, workshops and social events that allow students to experience achievement and progress as well as friendship and teamwork in a supportive and collaborative environment.

For students aspiring to professional careers, we offer advanced training in ballet, acro, dance technique, singing and drama, competition opportunities, Mountview 'triple-threat' vocational examinations, specialist 1:1 coaching, audition preparation and access to industry professionals through workshops and masterclasses. We provide guidance on further education pathways and support students preparing for auditions for vocational colleges and professional opportunities.

We are so proud of the achievements of our students outside of BSPA - with many of our students working professional contracts in the West End and touring productions as well as in TV and film and BSPA alumni going on to vocational training at highly prestigious colleges such as Arts Ed, Laine, Emil Dale Academy, Bird College and London Studio Centre.

All students learn alongside one another within a culture of mutual respect, where every individual's goals are valued equally. We believe that a student attending for enjoyment deserves the same level of care, encouragement and quality teaching as one pursuing a professional career.

4. What does safe guarding and student wellbeing look like in practice at your school? *

Safeguarding and the wellbeing of our students are at the heart of everything we do here at BSPA.

We maintain clear safeguarding policies and procedures, ensuring that all staff understand their responsibilities and undertake appropriate training.

We pride ourselves on maintaining an environment where students feel safe, respected and comfortable speaking to trusted adults. Open communication with parents and carers is encouraged and any concerns are acted upon promptly and appropriately.

Student wellbeing is extremely important to all staff at BSPA. Our teachers work carefully within age-appropriate expectations and the individual potential of each student alongside a healthy attitude towards performance, competition and achievement. We recognise that young people face increasing pressures both inside and outside of dance, and we work hard to ensure that BSPA remains a positive space where students feel supported, valued and able to be themselves.

We are committed to creating a culture that celebrates diversity, promotes inclusion and ensures that every student feels a sense of belonging regardless of their background, ability or aspirations.

All our staff work very closely together to look out for and communicate regularly with all our students, as well as seeking input from parents and the students themselves, to ensure that any potential concerns regarding the safety or wellbeing of any student is dealt with in a timely manner and with the upmost respect and discretion.

5. Why do you believe your school deserves this award? *

This past year has been truly transformational for BSPA, marked by the opening of our new premises, our incredible successes at prestigious competitions such as Dance World Cup, and All England Dance and the ever-increasing number of students wishing to join BSPA. In the past year alone, we have seen a 54% rise in the number of students enrolled at the school bringing our total enrolment to 169 students and new enquiries coming in every week!

We measure our success not only by competition results and achievements but also by the confidence, resilience and lifelong friendships our students develop during their time with us. We are proud to have built a thriving, inclusive community where students are encouraged to dream big while knowing they are supported every step of the way by our staff and by their classmates.

We believe BSPA stands out as a very special environment because we place equal importance on both achievement and student wellbeing. Every decision we make is driven by a desire to provide exceptional opportunities while ensuring that every student feels valued, supported and inspired.

We are incredibly proud of the community we have built, the outstanding performers that we have developed and the positive impact we continue to have on the lives of our students.

Google Forms